Week 10 at a Glance

Wednesday–Saturday, November 11 – 14, 2026 · about two hours each morning · AO Year 2 Term 1 week 10

EVERY SCHOOL DAY

- Outdoor sit or walk, 20 min
- Bible, 10–15 min, then narrate (Fri lighter)
- Hymn or folk song, 5 min
- Ray's New Practical Arithmetic, next lesson (29–32), 15–20 min
- Copywork, one line, 10 min
- Recitation, 5 min
- One main reading + narration
- One lighter reading or riches

HOLD ALL WEEK

Copywork: 'Come!' said Old Shellover. 'What?' says Creep.

Recitation: Genesis 1:1–2 ESV — from your physical Bible; wording not printed here. Keep verse 1 polished and work on verse 2. Optional: say "Bread and Cherries" by heart.

Hymn: "I Bind Unto Myself Today" — stanzas 1 and 2; no new stanza until both are easy

Folk song: "The Bold Grenadier" — the clearer sing-along recording on the shelf page

Math: Ray's Lessons 29–32. One lesson each school day. Oral first. Do not dump the book.

DAY	BIBLE	MAIN READING	RICHES / EXTRA
Wed 11	Exodus 31:18–32:35 + Awana	Our Island Story ch. 30, Gilbert and Rohesia	Ray's L29 · copywork · hymn · "Old Shellover"
Thu 12	Exodus 33 + Awana	Little Duke, ch. 5 second half (sitting 1)	Harvey's · Tree in the Trail ch. 8 · folk
Fri 13	hymn (lighter Bible)	Little Duke (sitting 2) · Burgess ch. 10	Grimm · picture study · composer · leaf placemat
Sat 14	Luke 22:1–13	Understood Betsy ch. 9	Harvey's · Pilgrim's Progress · CHOW "A Pirate's Great Grandson"

Books to have open

- ESV Bible (physical copy; references only)
- Ray's New Practical Arithmetic (Mott) — Lessons 29–32
- Harvey's Elementary Grammar (Mott) — two sittings
- *Our Island Story* ch. 30 · *Little Duke* ch. 5b (printed)
- *Tree in the Trail* ch. 8 — **your copy** (catch-up)
- Hillyer CHOW — "A Pirate's Great Grandson," **your copy**
- *Burgess* ch. 10 (11 opt.) · *Betsy* ch. 9 · Grimm's Pantheon
- Awana workbook (Wed + Thu) · McGuffey for Tracy

Two children

Astoria does the whole morning. Tracy joins Bible, songs, poems, animal stories, pictures, Grimm, the placemats, and outside (see her page).

Weather

Mid-November: cool fronts most weeks, chilly mornings, mild afternoons. Times slide; keep the order.

This week's shifts

Little Duke gets two sittings (Thu + Fri). **CHOW** goes on, Saturday. No Trial and Triumph, Shakespeare, or Cooper.

Readings and page numbers

Every public-domain sitting is printed in full. Edition pages let you find the same place in any copy of that edition; packet pages find it here.

DAY	READING	EDITION · PAGES	THIS PACKET
Wed	Our Island Story ch. 30 · Henry Plantagenet — The Story of Gilbert and Rohesia	Stokes / Constable, pp. 141–144	**pp. 11–12**
Wed	"Old Shellover" (de la Mare)	Constable 1924, p. 16	**p. 13**
Thu + Fri	The Little Duke ch. 5, second half (two sittings)	Macmillan, pp. 83–102	**pp. 17–21**
Fri	Burgess Animal Book ch. 10 · Prickly Porky and Grubby Gopher	Little, Brown 1920, pp. 82–89	**pp. 26–28**
Fri (opt.)	Burgess Animal Book ch. 11 · A Fellow With a Thousand Spears	Little, Brown 1920, pp. 90–98	**pp. 29–31**
Sat	Understood Betsy ch. 9 · The New Clothes Fail	Henry Holt 1917, pp. 186–200	**pp. 36–39**
Sat	The Pilgrim's Progress · the Interpreter's house: the dusty parlour to the valiant man	Dent 1910, pp. 31–35	**pp. 40–42**

FROM YOUR OWN SHELF · NOT PRINTED

- **Bible (ESV)** — Exodus 31:18–32:35 (Wed) · Exodus 33 (Thu) · Luke 22:1–13 (Sat). References only.
- **Tree in the Trail** (Holling) — ch. 8 (Thu).
- **A Child's History of the World** (Hillyer) — "A Pirate's Great Grandson" (ch. 52 in newer printings, ch. 50 in the 1924 first edition) (Sat).
- **Ray's New Practical Arithmetic** (Mott) — Lessons 29, 30, 31, 32, one a day.
- **Harvey's Elementary Grammar** (Mott) — next lesson, Thu and Sat.
- **Grimm's Fairy Tales** (Pantheon) — one gentle tale by title (Fri).
- **Awana workbook** — next page, Wed and Thu after Bible.
- **McGuffey Pictorial Primer** (Mott) — Tracy's picture pages, any day.

Page numbers come from the Internet Archive scans of each named edition (checked Oct 26, 2026). Other printings of the same book may run a page or two different.

Books on the shelf (and what waits)

What the house owns, what is assigned this week, and what waits. Copyrighted books are never reprinted.

YOU OWN THESE · USE FROM THE PHYSICAL COPY

Tree in the Trail (Holling) — catch-up this week: ch. 8 (~15–20 min, Thursday). Weeks 3–9 were ch. 1–7. Do **not** jump to AO Week 10's ch. 14–15. Never reprint.

Hillyer, A Child's History of the World — "A Pirate's Great Grandson" (ch. 52 modern / ch. 50 1st ed) on Saturday, from your copy. It comes right after Week 9's "Knights and Days of Chivalry." Never reprint.

Trial and Triumph (Hannula) — resting. Next chapter (Bernard of Clairvaux) comes in Term 2.

Seabird (Holling) — owned. Hold until around Week 19.

SHELF WEAVE THIS WEEK · INSIDE THE SAME MORNING

- **Ray's New Practical Arithmetic** (Mott) — Lessons 29–32; one lesson each school day; oral first.
- **Harvey's Elementary Grammar** (Mott) — two ~10 min sittings (Thu + Sat), next lesson from your place.
- **Grimm's Pantheon** — one gentle tale by title (suggested: "Mother Holle"). Never reprint.
- **McGuffey Pictorial Primer** (Mott) — Tracy's informal picture-page while Astoria does copywork or math.
- **Awana workbook** — Wed + Thu only, 10–15 min AFTER Bible, next page in the physical book. Never reprint.

FOLK SONG · THE CLEARER RECORDING

Keep using the plain sing-along "Bold Grenadier" that AmblesideOnline links: **youtu.be/9U631tf08sM** (folksandhymns channel). AO's folk-song page (amblesideonline.org/folksongs) lists two more recordings. Listen once, then sing a verse together.

BUY-AHEAD · WEEKS 12–13

Nothing to buy. Weeks 12–13 use public-domain readings (printed in the packets) and books you already own (Hillyer, *Tree in the Trail*, and *Trial and Triumph* when Term 2 begins). Diane Stanley's *Joan of Arc* is still around Weeks 22–25, so it's too early to buy. *Seabird* is already on your shelf for about Week 19.

One question first: Week 12 falls on Thanksgiving week (Wed Nov 25 – Sat Nov 28). Will you school that week, a short week, or take it off? The plan past Week 11 waits for your answer.

How to sit with them this week

Short lessons. One reading. Narration. Atmosphere. No teacher-book chapter to finish.

01 One reading, one telling

Read the passage once, at a good pace, and close the book. The single reading is what makes her listen. If you promise to read it again, she can stop paying attention the first time.

02 Hard stories, plainly read

The golden calf, ’Lias’s stepfather, and the King’s plot against Richard are all hard. Read them plainly, without a lecture afterward. Children can sit with wrongdoing in a story and come to their own right judgment of it. Answer any question she asks, and don’t add more.

03 A long chapter, two sittings

When a chapter is long, cut it at a natural pause and stop while she still wants more. Wanting to hear what comes next carries her into the next day, which works better than finishing a chapter she’s too tired to follow.

04 Let her ask the questions

After the narration, ask, “Was there anything you wondered about?” Her question tells you what she was thinking about while you read.

05 Masterly inactivity

With the cool fronts, afternoons are good for long free play outside. Don’t steer it. Unplanned outdoor time counts as part of the school day too.

06 Two children

Tracy joins the stories, songs, poems, Burgess, Grimm, picture study, the leaf placemats, and nature. She is not expected to narrate. Quiet play or McGuffey pictures during math and copywork.

07 Habit of attention in copywork

One line, done with care, is the lesson. She studies a word, then writes it without looking back at it. If the letters get sloppy, stop and try again tomorrow. Don’t make her write it over and over.

08 Recitation grows slowly

Genesis 1:1 is solid. Add verse 2 a phrase at a time: say it to her a few times each day and let her join in when she’s ready. Don’t drill it.

How to teach this week

Island Story ch. 30. Little Duke finishes ch. 5. Exodus 32–33 and Luke 22. CHOW from your shelf on Saturday.

01 Bible without a sermon

Wednesday: Exodus 31:18–32:35 (Moses receives the tablets; the people make a golden calf; Moses breaks the tablets and pleads for the people). Thursday: Exodus 33 (the tent of meeting; the cleft of the rock). Saturday: Luke 22:1–13 (Judas's bargain; the upper room). Friday: lighter, hymn first. ESV, physical copy only. **Intensity:** 32:25–29 tells of about three thousand killed. Pre-read; you may stop at verse 24.

02 Awana, Wed and Thu only

Ten to fifteen minutes AFTER Bible, next page, physical book. Never reprint. No Awana Fri or Sat.

03 Ray's Lessons 29–32

After Week 9's Lessons 25–28. One lesson a day, oral first. Do not dump pages.

04 Copywork and recitation

New line from de la Mare's "Old Shellover": *'Come!' said Old Shellover. 'What?' says Creep.* Best handwriting; point out the quotation marks. Recitation: Genesis 1:1–2 (ESV, reference only).

05 Island Story ch. 30 · Gilbert and Rohesia

Printed (about 1,050 words). Henry II sets England in order and chooses Thomas à Becket. Then Becket's parents: Gilbert, imprisoned on pilgrimage, is freed by Rohesia, who later finds him in London knowing only two English words. Marshall says it may be only a fairy tale.

06 Tree in the Trail, ch. 8

From **your copy**, Thursday, ~15–20 min. Catch-up (Weeks 3–9 were ch. 1–7); not AO's ch. 14–15. Never reprint.

07 Little Duke, ch. 5 second half · two sittings

Printed (about 3,500 words), cut at a natural pause. **Thursday:** Osmond holds the stair, Rouen shouts for its Duke, Bernard arrives. **Friday** (from "At a sign from the Count de Harcourt"): the King's oaths, and Richard leaves for France with Osmond.

08 Harvey's, twice

Two ~10-minute sittings (Thu, Sat), next lesson. Oral and light.

09 Grimm by title only

From your Pantheon: "Mother Holle" suggested (alternates "The Fisherman and His Wife," "The Star-Money"). Never reprint.

10 Burgess, one chapter (two if it goes well)

Ch. 10, "Prickly Porky and Grubby Gopher," is the week's chapter: Grubby the Pocket Gopher. If you read it as Week 9's optional, review briefly and go on to ch. 11, "A Fellow With a Thousand Spears" (printed, optional). Not AO's ch. 13.

11 CHOW · A Pirate's Great Grandson (Saturday)

From **your copy** (ch. 52 modern / ch. 50 1st ed). Rollo, Normandy, and William in 1066, the Little Duke's family. Never reprint.

12 What you are not doing

No Shakespeare, Trial and Triumph (Term 2), Cooper, Seabird (~Week 19), Parables from Nature, or Wind in the Willows.

How to teach this week

Betsy, Pilgrim's Progress, Hillyer, mid-November riches, and a handicraft.

13 Understood Betsy, ch. 9

"The New Clothes Fail." About 2,600 words; two sittings, Saturday to the marked break. The girls give 'Lias his new clothes and hope Mr. Pond will adopt him. **Intensity (pre-read):** the stepfather sells the clothes for whiskey, and Ralph says angry words ("darned old skunk," "I'd like to KILL him"). Happy ending: Mr. Pond carries 'Lias off.

14 Pilgrim's Progress · the Interpreter's house

After the first picture: the dusty parlour, Passion and Patience, the fire water can't quench, and the valiant man at the palace door. About 1,500 words; may stop after Passion and Patience.

15 Poetry: "Old Shellover"

De la Mare, *Peacock Pie*. Two snails wait until the gardener sleeps and the moon rises. Both children. Copywork from the first two lines.

16 Dictation (optional, Saturday)

She studies *Shellover*, *Creep*, and the quotation marks, then writes the line as you say it once. Five minutes; skip if tired.

17 Term 1 riches

Hymn: "I Bind Unto Myself Today," st. 1–2. Folk: "The Bold Grenadier" (clearer recording, shelf page). Picture: Rockwell, *Shuffleton's Barber Shop* (1950), next on AO's list after the Four Freedoms; look, turn over, describe. Composer: Bernstein, *Serenade (after Plato's Symposium)* (1954), next after *On the Town*; one movement while she draws. Nothing copyrighted is printed.

18 Nature · Lost Pines, mid-November

Cool fronts every few days. Sandhill cranes calling overhead; kinglets and yellow-rumped warblers in the pines. Red yaupon and possumhaw berries, scarlet flameleaf sumac, star-shaped sweetgum leaves and spiky gumballs, browning post oaks. After a damp night, look for snails like Old Shellover. One dated drawing, one scribed sentence.

19 Handicraft · leaf placemats

Wednesday: collect flat, bright leaves and press them in a heavy book. Friday: arrange on paper under clear contact paper for the Thanksgiving table. Twenty minutes. Tracy places leaves.

20 Preschool corner

Tracy's informal page is in this packet. Stories, songs, a snail game, McGuffey nearby, no worksheets.

21 Intensity / preview

A little heavier than Week 9 (golden calf, 'Lias's stepfather, Richard leaving home), but each reading ends hopefully. Week 11: Exodus 34–36, Luke 22:14–38, Island Story ch. 31 (Becket), Little Duke ch. 6a. **Before Week 12:** will you school Thanksgiving week (Nov 25–28)?

Tracy’s week

She joins what fits. She is not expected to narrate, copy, or sit through math.

01 Join freely

Nature sits and walks, Bible (as long as she’ll sit), the hymn and “The Bold Grenadier,” “Old Shellover,” the Burgess gopher (and porcupine) chapters, the Grimm tale, picture study, the Bernstein music, and the leaf placemats.

02 Nearby during hard work

McGuffey Pictorial Primer picture-pages, a busy-hands basket, or quiet play while Astoria does Ray’s, copywork, Island Story, Little Duke, CHOW, or Harvey’s.

03 Snail game

After the poem, Tracy is Creep. She curls up “asleep,” and when someone whispers “Come!” she creeps slowly across the rug. Do it once or twice, then stop. No worksheet.

04 Awana days

She may listen near Bible and Awana on Wed and Thu, or play in the same room. She does not do the workbook.

05 Outside is her classroom

Mid-November Lost Pines: red leaves, spiky sweetgum balls, red berries on the yaupon (look, don’t eat), a snail on a damp morning (watch it, don’t pick it up). Name one thing each day.

06 Leaf placemats

She helps pick leaves Wednesday. Friday she lays them on the paper wherever she likes. It goes on the table for Thanksgiving.

07 Feather-bed snow

After “Mother Holle,” shake a pillow or a sheet together and pretend it is snowing. Then stop.

08 What Tracy is not doing

No worksheets, no recitation, no scoring. If she’s fussy, the morning keeps its order and nothing more is added.

Wednesday

HAVE READY

Bible · Awana workbook · hymn words · Ray's (Lesson 29) · copywork line · *Our Island Story* ch. 30 (printed) · "Old Shellover" · a bag for leaves and a heavy book for pressing · nature notebook · McGuffey nearby

8:00 — **Nature walk + leaf hunt** TRACY JOINS

Twenty minutes. Collect a handful of flat, bright leaves for Friday's placemats. Press them in a heavy book. Listen for cranes overhead.

8:25 — **Bible · Exodus 31:18–32:35**

Open your ESV to Exodus 31:18. The tablets, the golden calf, and Moses pleading for the people. Read once, close the Bible, narrate, then stop. (Pre-read 32:25–29.)

8:40 — **Awana** AFTER BIBLE

Ten to fifteen minutes. Next page in the physical Awana book. Never reprint.

8:55 — **Hymn** TRACY JOINS

"I Bind Unto Myself Today," stanzas 1–2. Sing it; don't explain it.

9:05 — **Ray's · Lesson 29**

Next lesson after Week 9's Lesson 28. Oral first. One lesson. Tracy: McGuffey picture-page or busy-hands basket.

9:25 — **Copywork + recitation**

Copywork: *'Come!' said Old Shellover. 'What?' says Creep.* Recitation: Genesis 1:1–2 from your ESV (wording not printed).

9:40 — **History · Island Story ch. 30**

"Henry Plantagenet — The Story of Gilbert and Rohesia." Printed. Short (~8–10 min). Narrate. **Stop.**

10:00 — **Poem · "Old Shellover"** TRACY JOINS

Read once. Both children. Then Tracy's snail game, once.

How to teach Wednesday

> **Island Story ch. 30.** Printed in full and short. The golden calf in Exodus is the big story today, so keep everything else light.

Bible and Awana

Exodus 31:18–32:35. Moses comes down with the two tablets and finds the people dancing around a golden calf. He breaks the tablets, grinds up the calf, and then goes back up to plead with God for the people. Verses 25–29 tell of a slaughter in the camp, so pre-read them and decide whether to read them today or stop at verse 24. One reading; let her narrate. Awana after Bible, physical book only.

Ray’s Lesson 29

Pick up the Mott Ray’s where Week 9 stopped. Oral first. Stop after one lesson even if she’s eager.

Island Story

Henry II, the first Plantagenet, sets England in order. He makes the barons pull down their castles and chooses Thomas à Becket to help him. Then the story of Becket’s parents: Gilbert in the Saracen prison, Rohesia with the stolen keys, and her long journey calling “London” and then “Gilbert” through the streets. Ask her how Rohesia found him. Next week is Becket himself.

Poem

“Old Shellover” is this week’s poem and copywork. Two snails plotting a moonlit outing. Read it for delight; no lesson.

Tracy: leaf hunt, Bible as long as she’ll sit, hymn, poem and snail game. McGuffey or the busy-hands basket during Ray’s and copywork. She may stay for Island Story if she is quiet.

READ THIS · WEDNESDAY

Bible · Exodus 31:18–32:35

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Exodus 31:18–32:35.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.
The tablets and the golden calf; Moses pleads for the people. Pre-read 32:25–29.

READ THIS · WEDNESDAY

Our Island Story · Chapter 30 · Henry Plantagenet — The Story of Gilbert and Rohesia

*H. E. Marshall, An Island Story: A Child's History of England (New York: Frederick A. Stokes; printed in Edinburgh by T. and A. Constable), ch. XXX, **pp. 141–144**. Same text as Our Island Story (London: T. C. & E. C. Jack, 1905). Public domain. Full chapter. · This packet: pp. 11–12*

Henry II., as you know, got his name Plantagenet from his father, Geoffrey of Anjou, who used to wear a piece of planta genista in his helmet. He was the first of several kings ruling England who were all Plantagenets.

Henry II. was only twenty-one years old when he began to reign, and, like his grandfather, Henry Beauclerc, he reigned thirty-five years. Like him, too, he did much to draw the English and Norman people together.

The misrule and confusion of the reign of Stephen had been so great, that Henry had to work very hard to bring his kingdom into order again. He not only worked hard himself, but he made other people work too. It is said of him that he never sat down, but was on his feet all day long.

The first thing Henry did was to send away all the foreign soldiers who had come to England to help Stephen and Matilda in their wars. Next he made the barons pull down their castles in which they used to do such dreadful deeds of cruelty. He told them they must live in ordinary houses and not in fortresses which could be turned into fearful prisons and places of torture.

The barons were very angry; but, like his grandfather, Henry Beauclerc, Henry II. was stern, and forced people to obey him.

These are only a few of the things which he did, for the reign of Henry II. was a great one. To help and advise him in his work, Henry chose a man called Thomas a Becket.

Thomas a Becket's father was called Gilbert, and his mother Rohesia. Gilbert was a London merchant, and when he was young he had made a pilgrimage to the Holy Land, as was common in those days.

At that time Jerusalem was in the hands of people called Saracens. They were pagans and hated the Christians, and they treated very badly those who came to visit the sepulchre of Christ.

While Gilbert was on his pilgrimage, a rich Saracen seized and put him in prison, saying he should not come out until he had paid a great sum of money.

This Saracen had a beautiful daughter. Rohesia, for that was her name, had seen the handsome young Englishman before her father put him into prison, and she felt sorry for him. She used to come to the little window of his cell to speak to him, and to bring him things to eat and drink.

Night after night she came, and they whispered to each other through the bars of the little prison window. There was no one to hear, and only the stars and the moon to keep watch. All day long Gilbert used to wait impatiently until night came, when Rohesia would creep quietly to the window, and he would hear her whisper, 'Gilbert, Gilbert,' and she would slip her little hand through the bars and touch his.

Rohesia could speak no English, but Gilbert could speak her language, and he taught her to say his name. She learned to say London too, and knew that that was where he lived.

Gilbert and Rohesia grew to love each other very much, and all the day seemed long and dreary until night came and they could whisper to each other through the prison bars. But one night Rohesia came breathless and pale. 'Gilbert,' she whispered, 'Gilbert, my father is asleep, and I have stolen the keys. I will unlock the door. You are free.'

Gilbert hardly believed the good news until he heard the key turn in the lock. Then the door swung open and he knew that he was indeed free. He took Rohesia in his arms and kissed her, promising that he would never forget her. ‘As soon as I get back to England, I shall send for you,’ he said. ‘You must come to me, and we shall be married and never part any more.’

Then Gilbert went away and Rohesia was left all alone. She felt very sad after he had gone, but she comforted herself always by remembering that he was going to send for her, and that then they should be together and happy ever after.

Gilbert arrived safely in England, but he forgot all about the beautiful Saracen maiden and his promise to her. He had so many things to do when he got back to London that the time for him went very quickly. But for Rohesia the time passed slowly, slowly. Day after day went by. In the morning she said, ‘To-day he will send.’ In the evening she wept, and said, ‘He has not sent.’

At last she could bear the waiting no longer, so she set out to try to find Gilbert. She knew only two words of English, but she was not afraid. She travelled all through the land until she reached the seashore. There she said, ‘London, London,’ to every one whom she met until at last she found a ship that was going there. She had not much money, but she gave the captain some of her jewels, and he was kind to her and landed her safely in London.

London in those days was much smaller than it is now, but Rohesia had never seen so many houses and people before, and she was bewildered and frightened. Every one turned to stare at the lovely lady dressed in such strange and beautiful clothes, who kept calling, ‘Gilbert, Gilbert,’ as she passed from street to street.

Gilbert was sitting in his house when suddenly he heard his name. He knew the voice, yet he could hardly believe his ears. Could it indeed be Rohesia? In a flash he remembered everything. The dark little prison. The lovely Saracen girl. His love for, his promise to, her. He ran to the door and opened it quickly. The next minute Rohesia was sobbing in his arms. Her long journey was ended. She had found Gilbert,

As Gilbert held Rohesia in his arms, he found all his old love for her had come back. So they were married and were happy. They had a little son whom they called Thomas. He grew up to be that Thomas a Becket, who was King Henry’s great chancellor and friend.

I must tell you that some people say that this story of Gilbert and Rohesia is only a fairy tale. Perhaps it is.

> **End of chapter.** Narrate. Next week: ch. 31, Henry Plantagenet — The Story of Thomas à Becket.

READ THIS · WEDNESDAY

Old Shellover

Walter de la Mare, Peacock Pie: A Book of Rhymes (London: Constable; 1924 printing), ***p. 16****. Text: Project Gutenberg #3753 (1913). Public domain. This week's copywork comes from here. · This packet: p. 13*

'Come!' said Old Shellover.
'What?' says Creep.
'The horny old Gardener's fast asleep;
The fat cock Thrush
To his nest has gone;
And the dew shines bright
In the rising Moon;
Old Sallie Worm from her hole doth peep:
Come!' said Old Shellover.
'Aye!' said Creep.

> **Copywork:** 'Come!' said Old Shellover. 'What?' says Creep.

Thursday

HAVE READY

Bible · Awana workbook · Ray's (Lesson 30) · *The Little Duke* ch. 5 second half (printed, sitting 1) · *Tree in the Trail* (your copy, ch. 8) · Harvey's · folk song recording · McGuffey nearby

8:00 — **Nature sit** TRACY JOINS

Porch or backyard, twenty minutes. Feel the morning after a cool front. Find one red leaf and one red berry.

8:25 — **Bible · Exodus 33**

Moses and God in the tent of meeting; the cleft of the rock. Read once, narrate, stop.

8:40 — **Awana** AFTER BIBLE

Ten to fifteen minutes. Next page. Then put it away.

8:55 — **Folk song** TRACY JOINS

"The Bold Grenadier," with the clearer sing-along recording (shelf page). One verse.

9:05 — **Ray's · Lesson 30**

One lesson. Oral first. Tracy nearby with McGuffey.

9:25 — **Tales · Little Duke ch. 5b, sitting 1**

Printed. Osmond on the stair, the shout of Rouen, Count Bernard. Stop at the marked break (~12 min). Narrate.

9:50 — **Geography · Tree in the Trail ch. 8**

From your copy, ~15–20 min. Narrate. Do not jump ahead to AO's ch. 14–15.

10:15 — **Harvey's · short sitting**

About ten minutes, next lesson, oral and light. Then stop.

How to teach Thursday

> **Little Duke, first sitting.** Tree in the Trail from your copy. Harvey's first sitting. Copywork can go here if Wednesday was full.

Bible and Awana

Exodus 33. God says He will not go up in the midst of the people, and they mourn. Moses pitches the tent of meeting outside the camp, and the pillar of cloud comes down. Moses asks to see God's glory and is hidden in the cleft of the rock while it passes by. Read it straight through once. Awana after.

Little Duke

Richard is hidden in the turret. Osmond holds the narrow stair and answers the Franks in their own language. Then the people of Rouen surround the castle, shouting for their Duke. Count Bernard comes in, and Richard is brought to the council-room to face the King. Bernard tells Louis to swear at the window, in front of the people, that he means Richard no harm. Stop at the marked break. Ask why Osmond chose the stair.

Tree in the Trail

Chapter 8, from your physical book. One sitting. Find the place on the trail map if your copy has one. Never reprint.

Harvey's

First of two short sittings. Oral. Next lesson from your place.

Tracy: nature, Bible, folk song. McGuffey during Ray's and Harvey's. She may listen to Little Duke if she is content.

READ THIS · THURSDAY

Bible · Exodus 33

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Exodus 33.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.
The tent of meeting; Moses in the cleft of the rock. One chapter — Awana follows.

READ THIS · THURSDAY + FRIDAY

The Little Duke · Chapter 5 · second half

Charlotte M. Yonge, The Little Duke (London & New York: Macmillan), ch. V, second half, ***pp. 83–102*** *(Macmillan printing scanned at the Internet Archive; the second sitting begins on p. 91). Text: Project Gutenberg #3048, from the 1905 Macmillan edition. Public domain. · This packet: pp. 17–21*

“Hark!” said Osmond, “what a tramping the Franks are making. They are beginning to wonder where the Duke is.”

“To the stairs, Osmond,” said Sir Eric. “On that narrow step one man may keep them at bay a long time. You can speak their jargon too, and hold parley with them.”

“Perhaps they will think I am gone,” whispered Richard, “if they cannot find me, and go away.”

Osmond and two of the Normans were, as he spoke, taking their stand on the narrow spiral stair, where there was just room for one man on the step. Osmond was the lowest, the other two above him, and it would have been very hard for an enemy to force his way past them.

Osmond could plainly hear the sounds of the steps and voices of the French as they consulted together, and sought for the Duke. A man at length was heard clanking up these very stairs, till winding round, he suddenly found himself close upon young de Centeville.

“Ha! Norman!” he cried, starting back in amazement, “what are you doing here?”

“My duty,” answered Osmond, shortly. “I am here to guard this stair;” and his drawn sword expressed the same intention.

The Frenchman drew back, and presently a whispering below was heard, and soon after a voice came up the stairs, saying, “Norman—good Norman—“

“What would you say?” replied Osmond, and the head of another Frank appeared. “What means all this, my friend?” was the address. “Our King comes as a guest to you, and you received him last evening as loyal vassals. Wherefore have you now drawn out of the way, and striven to bear off your young Duke into secret places? Truly it looks not well that you should thus strive to keep him apart, and therefore the King requires to see him instantly.”

“Sir Frenchman,” replied Osmond, “your King claims the Duke as his ward. How that may be my father knows not, but as he was committed to his charge by the states of Normandy, he holds himself bound to keep him in his own hands until further orders from them.”

“That means, insolent Norman, that you intend to shut the boy up and keep him in your own rebel hands. You had best yield—it will be the better for you and for him. The child is the King’s ward, and he shall not be left to be nurtured in rebellion by northern pirates.”

At this moment a cry from without arose, so loud as almost to drown the voices of the speakers on the turret stair, a cry welcome to the ears of Osmond, repeated by a multitude of voices, “Haro! Haro! our little Duke!”

It was well known as a Norman shout. So just and so ready to redress all grievances had the old Duke Rollo been, that his very name was an appeal against injustice, and whenever wrong was done, the Norman outcry against the injury was always “Ha Rollo!” or as it had become shortened, “Haro.” And now Osmond knew that those whose affection had been won by the uprightness of Rollo, were gathering to protect his helpless grandchild.

The cry was likewise heard by the little garrison in the turret chamber, bringing hope and joy. Richard thought himself already rescued, and springing from Fru Astrida, danced about in ecstasy, only longing to see the faithful Normans, whose voices he heard ringing out again and again, in calls for their little Duke, and outcries against the Franks. The windows were, however, so high, that nothing could be seen from them but the sky; and, like Richard, the old Baron de Centeville was almost beside himself with anxiety to know what force was gathered together, and

what measures were being taken. He opened the door, called to his son, and asked if he could tell what was passing, but Osmond knew as little—he could see nothing but the black, cobwebbed, dusty steps winding above his head, while the clamours outside, waxing fiercer and louder, drowned all the sounds which might otherwise have come up to him from the French within the Castle. At last, however, Osmond called out to his father, in Norse, “There is a Frank Baron come to entreat, and this time very humbly, that the Duke may come to the King.”

“Tell him,” replied Sir Eric, “that save with consent of the council of Normandy, the child leaves not my hands.”

“He says,” called back Osmond, after a moment, “that you shall guard him yourself, with as many as you choose to bring with you. He declares on the faith of a free Baron, that the King has no thought of ill—he wants to show him to the Rouennais without, who are calling for him, and threaten to tear down the tower rather than not see their little Duke. Shall I bid him send a hostage?”

“Answer him,” returned the Baron, “that the Duke leaves not this chamber unless a pledge is put into our hands for his safety. There was an oily-tongued Count, who sat next the King at supper—let him come hither, and then perchance I may trust the Duke among them.”

Osmond gave the desired reply, which was carried to the King. Meantime the uproar outside grew louder than ever, and there were new sounds, a horn was winded, and there was a shout of “*Dieu aide*!” the Norman war-cry, joined with “Notre Dame de Harcourt!”

“There, there!” cried Sir Eric, with a long breath, as if relieved of half his anxieties, “the boy has sped well. Bernard is here at last! Now his head and hand are there, I doubt no longer.”

“Here comes the Count,” said Osmond, opening the door, and admitting a stout, burly man, who seemed sorely out of breath with the ascent of the steep, broken stair, and very little pleased to find himself in such a situation. The Baron de Centeville augured well from the speed with which he had been sent, thinking it proved great perplexity and distress on the part of Louis. Without waiting to hear his hostage speak, he pointed to a chest on which he had been sitting, and bade two of his men-at-arms stand on each side of the Count, saying at the same time to Fru Astrida, “Now, mother, if aught of evil befalls the child, you know your part. Come, Lord Richard.”

Richard moved forward. Sir Eric held his hand. Osmond kept close behind him, and with as many of the men-at-arms as could be spared from guarding Fru Astrida and her hostage, he descended the stairs, not by any means sorry to go, for he was weary of being besieged in that turret chamber, whence he could see nothing, and with those friendly cries in his ears, he could not be afraid.

He was conducted to the large council-room which was above the hall. There, the King was walking up and down anxiously, looking paler than his wont, and no wonder, for the uproar sounded tremendous there—and now and then a stone dashed against the sides of the deep window.

Nearly at the same moment as Richard entered by one door, Count Bernard de Harcourt came in from the other, and there was a slight lull in the tumult.

“What means this, my Lords?” exclaimed the King. “Here am I come in all good will, in memory of my warm friendship with Duke William, to take on me the care of his orphan, and hold council with you for avenging his death, and is this the greeting you afford me? You steal away the child, and stir up the rascaille of Rouen against me. Is this the reception for your King?”

“Sir King,” replied Bernard, “what your intentions may be, I know not. All I do know is, that the burghers of Rouen are fiercely incensed against you—so much so, that they were almost ready to tear me to pieces for being absent at this juncture. They say that you are keeping the child prisoner in his own Castle and that they will have him restored if they tear it down to the foundations.”

“You are a true man, a loyal man—you understand my good intentions,” said Louis, trembling, for the Normans were extremely dreaded. “You would not bring the shame of rebellion on your town and people. Advise me—I will do just as you counsel me—how shall I appease them?”

“Take the child, lead him to the window, swear that you mean him no evil, that you will not take him from us,” said Bernard. “Swear it on the faith of a King.”

“As a King—as a Christian, it is true!” said Louis. “Here, my boy! Wherefore shrink from me? What have I done, that you should fear me? You have been listening to evil tales of me, my child. Come hither.”

> **Stop here on Thursday.** Narrate. Friday picks up at the window (Macmillan p. 91).

FRIDAY · SECOND SITTING

At a sign from the Count de Harcourt, Sir Eric led Richard forward, and put his hand into the King’s. Louis took him to the window, lifted him upon the sill, and stood there with his arm round him, upon which the shout, “Long live Richard, our little Duke!” arose again. Meantime, the two Centevilles looked in wonder at the old Harcourt, who shook his head and muttered in his own tongue, “I will do all I may, but our force is small, and the King has the best of it. We must not yet bring a war on ourselves.”

“Hark! he is going to speak,” said Osmond.

“Fair Sirs!—excellent burgesses!” began the King, as the cries lulled a little. “I rejoice to see the love ye bear to our young Prince! I would all my subjects were equally loyal! But wherefore dread me, as if I were come to injure him? I, who came but to take counsel how to avenge the death of his father, who brought me back from England when I was a friendless exile. Know ye not how deep is the debt of gratitude I owe to Duke William? He it was who made me King—it was he who gained me the love of the King of Germany; he stood godfather for my son—to him I owe all my wealth and state, and all my care is to render guerdon for it to his child, since, alas! I may not to himself. Duke William rests in his bloody grave! It is for me to call his murderers to account, and to cherish his son, even as mine own!”

So saying, Louis tenderly embraced the little boy, and the Rouennais below broke out into another cry, in which “Long live King Louis,” was joined with “Long live Richard!”

“You will not let the child go?” said Eric, meanwhile, to Harcourt.

“Not without provision for his safety, but we are not fit for war as yet, and to let him go is the only means of warding it off.”

Eric groaned and shook his head; but the Count de Harcourt’s judgment was of such weight with him, that he never dreamt of disputing it.

“Bring me here,” said the King, “all that you deem most holy, and you shall see me pledge myself to be your Duke’s most faithful friend.”

There was some delay, during which the Norman Nobles had time for further counsel together, and Richard looked wistfully at them, wondering what was to happen to him, and wishing he could venture to ask for Alberic.

Several of the Clergy of the Cathedral presently appeared in procession, bringing with them the book of the Gospels on which Richard had taken his installation oath, with others of the sacred treasures of the Church, preserved in gold cases. The Priests were followed by a few of the Norman Knights and Nobles, some of the burgesses of Rouen, and, to Richard’s great joy, by Alberic de Montemar himself. The two boys stood looking eagerly at each other, while preparation was made for the ceremony of the King’s oath.

The stone table in the middle of the room was cleared, and arranged so as in some degree to resemble the Altar in the Cathedral; then the Count de Harcourt, standing before it, and holding the King’s hand, demanded of him whether he would undertake to be the friend, protector, and good Lord of Richard, Duke of Normandy, guarding him from all his enemies, and ever seeking his welfare. Louis, with his hand on the Gospels, “swore that so he would.”

“Amen!” returned Bernard the Dane, solemnly, “and as thou keepest that oath to the fatherless child, so may the Lord do unto thine house!”

Then followed the ceremony, which had been interrupted the night before, of the homage and oath of allegiance which Richard owed to the King, and, on the other hand, the King's formal reception of him as a vassal, holding, under him, the two dukedoms of Normandy and Brittany. "And," said the King, raising him in his arms and kissing him, "no dearer vassal do I hold in all my realm than this fair child, son of my murdered friend and benefactor—precious to me as my own children, as so on my Queen and I hope to testify."

Richard did not much like all this embracing; but he was sure the King really meant him no ill, and he wondered at all the distrust the Centevilles had shown.

"Now, brave Normans," said the King, "be ye ready speedily, for an onset on the traitor Fleming. The cause of my ward is my own cause. Soon shall the trumpet be sounded, the ban and arriere ban of the realm be called forth, and Arnulf, in the flames of his cities, and the blood of his vassals, shall learn to rue the day when his foot trod the Isle of Pecquigny! How many Normans can you bring to the muster, Sir Count?"

"I cannot say, within a few hundreds of lances," replied the old Dane, cautiously; "it depends on the numbers that may be engaged in the Italian war with the Saracens, but of this be sure, Sir King, that every man in Normandy and Brittany who can draw a sword or bend a bow, will stand forth in the cause of our little Duke; ay, and that his blessed father's memory is held so dear in our northern home, that it needs but a message to King Harold Blue-tooth to bring a fleet of long keels into the Seine, with stout Danes enough to carry fire and sword, not merely through Flanders, but through all France. We of the North are not apt to forget old friendships and favours, Sir King."

"Yes, yes, I know the Norman faith of old," returned Louis, uneasily, "but we should scarcely need such wild allies as you propose; the Count of Paris, and Hubert of Senlis may be reckoned on, I suppose."

"No truer friend to Normandy than gallant and wise old Hugh the White!" said Bernard, "and as to Senlis, he is uncle to the boy, and doubly bound to us."

"I rejoice to see your confidence," said Louis. "You shall soon hear from me. In the meantime I must return to gather my force together, and summon my great vassals, and I will, with your leave, brave Normans, take with me my dear young ward. His presence will plead better in his cause than the finest words; moreover, he will grow up in love and friendship with my two boys, and shall be nurtured with them in all good learning and chivalry, nor shall he ever be reminded that he is an orphan while under the care of Queen Gerberge and myself."

"Let the child come to me, so please you, my Lord the King," answered Harcourt, bluntly. "I must hold some converse with him, ere I can reply."

"Go then, Richard," said Louis, "go to your trusty vassal—happy are you in possessing such a friend; I hope you know his value."

"Here then, young Sir," said the Count, in his native tongue, when Richard had crossed from the King's side, and stood beside him, "what say you to this proposal?"

"The King is very kind," said Richard. "I am sure he is kind; but I do not like to go from Rouen, or from Dame Astrida."

"Listen, my Lord," said the Dane, stooping down and speaking low. "The King is resolved to have you away; he has with him the best of his Franks, and has so taken us at unawares, that though I might yet rescue you from his hands, it would not be without a fierce struggle, wherein you might be harmed, and this castle and town certainly burnt, and wrested from us. A few weeks or months, and we shall have time to draw our force together, so that Normandy need fear no man, and for that time you must tarry with him."

"Must I—and all alone?"

"No, not alone, not without the most trusty guardian that can be found for you. Friend Eric, what say you?" and he laid his hand on the old Baron's shoulder. "Yet, I know not; true thou art, as a Norwegian mountain, but I doubt me if thy brains are not too dull to see through the French wiles and disguises, sharp as thou didst show thyself last night."

“That was Osmond, not I,” said Sir Eric. “He knows their mincing tongue better than I. He were the best to go with the poor child, if go he must.”

“Bethink you, Eric,” said the Count, in an undertone, “Osmond is the only hope of your good old house—if there is foul play, the guardian will be the first to suffer.”

“Since you think fit to peril the only hope of all Normandy, I am not the man to hold back my son where he may aid him,” said old Eric, sadly. “The poor child will be lonely and uncared-for there, and it were hard he should not have one faithful comrade and friend with him.”

“It is well,” said Bernard: “young as he is, I had rather trust Osmond with the child than any one else, for he is ready of counsel, and quick of hand.”

“Ay, and a pretty pass it is come to,” muttered old Centeville, “that we, whose business it is to guard the boy, should send him where you scarcely like to trust my son.”

Bernard paid no further attention to him, but, coming forward, required another oath from the King, that Richard should be as safe and free at his court as at Rouen, and that on no pretence whatsoever should he be taken from under the immediate care of his Esquire, Osmond Fitz Eric, heir of Centeville.

After this, the King was impatient to depart, and all was preparation. Bernard called Osmond aside to give full instructions on his conduct, and the means of communicating with Normandy, and Richard was taking leave of Fru Astrida, who had now descended from her turret, bringing her hostage with her. She wept much over her little Duke, praying that he might safely be restored to Normandy, even though she might not live to see it; she exhorted him not to forget the good and holy learning in which he had been brought up, to rule his temper, and, above all, to say his prayers constantly, never leaving out one, as the beads of his rosary reminded him of their order. As to her own grandson, anxiety for him seemed almost lost in her fears for Richard, and the chief things she said to him, when he came to take leave of her, were directions as to the care he was to take of the child, telling him the honour he now received was one which would make his name forever esteemed if he did but fulfil his trust, the most precious that Norman had ever yet received.

“I will, grandmother, to the very best of my power,” said Osmond; “I may die in his cause, but never will I be faithless!”

“Alberic!” said Richard, “are you glad to be going back to Montemar?”

“Yes, my Lord,” answered Alberic, sturdily, “as glad as you will be to come back to Rouen.”

“Then I shall send for you directly, Alberic, for I shall never love the Princes Carloman and Lothaire half as well as you!”

“My Lord the King is waiting for the Duke,” said a Frenchman, coming forward.

“Farewell then, Fru Astrida. Do not weep. I shall soon come back. Farewell, Alberic. Take the bar-tailed falcon back to Montemar, and keep him for my sake. Farewell, Sir Eric—Farewell, Count Bernard. When the Normans come to conquer Arnulf you will lead them. O dear, dear Fru Astrida, farewell again.”

“Farewell, my own darling. The blessing of Heaven go with you, and bring you safe home! Farewell, Osmond. Heaven guard you and strengthen you to be his shield and his defence!”

> **End of chapter 5.** Narrate. Next week: chapter 6, first half — Richard in France.

OPEN YOUR COPY · THURSDAY

Tree in the Trail · Chapter 8

Holling C. Holling — owned copy · never reprinted in this packet

Open your Tree in the Trail to chapter 8.

One sitting, ~15–20 min. Read once, narrate, stop.

Catch-up: Weeks 3–9 were ch. 1–7. Do not jump to AO Week 10’s ch. 14–15.

Never reprint Holling.

READ THIS · THURSDAY · FROM YOUR SHELF

Harvey’s Elementary Grammar · short sitting

Mott Media reprint · owned copy · never reprinted

Open Harvey’s to your place.

About ten minutes. Oral and light. First sitting of the week. Stop.

Do not dump the book.

Friday

HAVE READY

Hymn words · Ray's (Lesson 31) · *Little Duke* (sitting 2, printed) · *Burgess* ch. 10 (printed; ch. 11 optional) · Grimm's Pantheon · Rockwell *Shuffleton's Barber Shop* (book or screen) · Bernstein *Serenade* · pressed leaves, paper, clear contact paper · McGuffey nearby

8:00 — **Nature sit** TRACY JOINS

Twenty minutes. Sweetgum balls, sumac, a snail if the morning is damp.

8:25 — **Hymn · lighter Bible day**

Sing stanzas 1–2. No new passage today.

8:35 — **Ray's · Lesson 31**

One lesson. Oral first.

8:55 — **Tales · Little Duke ch. 5b, sitting 2**

Printed, from "At a sign from the Count de Harcourt." The King's oath and Richard's farewell. ~14 min. Narrate. Chapter 5 done.

9:15 — **Nature lore · Burgess ch. 10** TRACY JOINS

Prickly Porky and Grubby Gopher. Printed. Narrate. Ch. 11 (the porcupine) only if she asks for more, or if ch. 10 was read last week.

9:40 — **Grimm · by title** TRACY JOINS

From your Pantheon. "Mother Holle" suggested. One tale. Narrate.

9:55 — **Picture study + composer** TRACY JOINS

Rockwell *Shuffleton's Barber Shop*: look, turn it over, describe it. Then one movement of Bernstein's *Serenade* while she draws.

10:15 — **Handicraft · leaf placemats** TRACY JOINS

Arrange the pressed leaves, cover with contact paper, trim. Twenty minutes, then stop.

How to teach Friday

> **No Awana. Lighter Bible.** Two printed readings today (Little Duke and Burgess), so give each its own narration with a song or a stretch between. Handicraft last.

Little Duke

Louis swears at the window, and the crowd cheers. Then he swears again on the relics from the cathedral and asks the Normans to help him fight Count Arnulf. Bernard thinks it safer to let Richard go to France than to start a war now, so Osmond goes with him as his guard. Richard says goodbye to everyone and gives Alberic the falcon. Ask why Bernard let him go.

Burgess

Ch. 10 is the week's chapter. It is about Grubby the Pocket Gopher, who digs tunnels like Miner the Mole and carries food in fur-lined pockets on the outside of his cheeks. It ends with Prickly Porky arriving. If you already read it as Week 9's optional sitting, review it in one minute and go on to ch. 11, "A Fellow With a Thousand Spears."

Grimm

"Mother Holle" (or "The Fisherman and His Wife" / "The Star-Money" if it's familiar). One tale. Close the book. Let her tell it.

Picture study and composer

Shuffleton's Barber Shop shows a small-town barber shop at night, closed. Through the doorway, men play music in a lit back room. Ask what she found first and what is happening in the back room. Bernstein's *Serenade* is for violin and orchestra, written about friends talking at a dinner. Just listen.

Handicraft

Leaf placemats. Lay leaves on construction paper, cover with clear contact paper, and trim the edges. Make one for each place at the Thanksgiving table if there's time, but stop at twenty minutes.

Tracy: nature, hymn, Burgess, Grimm, picture study, music, leaf placemats. McGuffey during Ray's and Little Duke.

READ THIS · FRIDAY

The Burgess Animal Book · Chapter 10 · Prickly Porky and Grubby Gopher

Thornton W. Burgess, The Burgess Animal Book for Children (Boston: Little, Brown, 1920), ch. X, ***pp. 82–89****. Text: Project Gutenberg #2441. Public domain. Full chapter (printed as optional in Week 9). · This packet: pp. 26–28*

All the way to school the next morning Peter Rabbit wondered who they would learn about that day. He was so busy wondering that he was heedless. Peter is apt to be heedless at times. The result was that as he hopped out of a bramble-tangle just within the edge of the Green Forest, he all but landed in something worse than the worst brambles that ever grew. It was only by a wild side jump that he saved himself. Peter had almost landed among the thousand little spears of Prickly Porky the Porcupine.

“Gracious!” exclaimed Peter.

“Why don’t you look where you are going,” grunted Prickly Porky. Plainly he was rather peevish. “It wouldn’t be my fault if you had a few of my little spears sticking in you this very minute, and it would serve you right.” He waddled along a few steps, then began talking again. “I don’t see why Old Mother Nature sent for me this morning,” he grumbled. “I hate a long walk.”

Peter pricked up his long ears. “I know!” he cried. “You’re going to school, Prickly Porky. You’re a Rodent, and we are going to learn all about you this morning.”

“I’m not a Rodent; I’m a Porcupine,” grunted Prickly Porky indignantly.

“You’re a Rodent just the same. You’ve got big gnawing teeth, and any one with that kind of teeth is a Rodent,” retorted Peter. Then at a sudden thought a funny look passed over his face. “Why, that means that you and I are related in a way,” he added.

“Don’t believe it,” grunted Prickly Porky, still shuffling along. “Don’t believe it. Don’t want to be related to anybody as heedless as you. What is this school, anyway? Don’t want to go to school. Know all I want to know. Know how to get all I want to eat and how to make everybody get out of my way and leave me alone, and that’s enough to know.” He rattled the thousand little spears hidden in his coat, and Peter shivered at the sound. It was a most unpleasant sound.

“Well, some folks do like to be stupid,” snapped Peter and hurried on, lipperty-lipperty-lip, while Prickly Porky slowly shuffled and rattled along behind.

All the others were there when Peter arrived. Prickly Porky wasn’t even in sight. Old Mother Nature wasted no time. She has too much to do ever to waste time. She called the school to order at once.

“Yesterday,” she began, “I told you about two little haymakers of the high mountains of the Far West. Who were they, Peter Rabbit?”

“Little Chief Hare, called the Pika or Cony, and Stubtail the Mountain Beaver or Sewellel,” replied Peter with great promptness.

“Right,” said Old Mother Nature. “Now I am going to tell you of one of my little plowmen who also lives in the Far West but prefers the great plains to the high mountains, though he is sometimes found in the latter. He is Grubby the Gopher, a member of the same order the rest of you belong to, but of a family quite his own. He is properly called the Pocket Gopher, and way down in the Southeast, where he is also found, he is called a Salamander, though what for I haven’t the least idea.”

“Does he have pockets in his cheeks like mine?” asked Striped Chipmunk eagerly.

“He has pockets in his cheeks, and that is why he is called Pocket Gopher,” replied Old Mother Nature; “but they are not at all like yours, Striped Chipmunk. Yours are on the inside of your cheeks, but his are on the outside.”

“How funny!” exclaimed Striped Chipmunk.

“Your pockets are small compared with those of Grubby,” continued Old Mother Nature. “One of his covers almost the whole side of his head back to his short neck, and it is lined with fur, and remember he has two of them. Grubby uses these for carrying food and never for carrying out earth when he is digging a tunnel, as some folks think he does. He stuffs them full with his front feet and empties them by pressing them from the back with his feet. The Gopher family is quite large and the members range in size from the size of Danny Meadow Mouse to that of Robber the Rat, only these bigger members are stouter and heavier than Robber. Some are reddish-brown and some are gray. But whatever his size and wherever he is found, Grubby’s habits are the same.”

All this time Peter Rabbit had been fidgeting about. It was quite clear that Peter had something on his mind. Now as Old Mother Nature paused, Peter found the chance he had been waiting for. “If you please, why did you call him a plowman?” he asked eagerly.

“I’m coming to that all in due time,” replied Old Mother Nature, smiling at Peter’s eagerness. “Grubby Gopher spends most of his life underground, very much like Miner the Mole, whom you all know. He can dig tunnels just about as fast. His legs are short, and his front legs and feet are very stout and strong. They are armed with very long, strong claws and it is with these and the help of his big cutting teeth that Grubby digs. He throws the earth under him and then kicks it behind him with his hind feet. When he has quite a pile behind him he turns around, and with his front feet and head pushes it along to a little side tunnel and then up to the surface of the ground. As soon as he has it all out he plugs up the opening and goes back to digging. The loose earth he has pushed out makes little mounds, and he makes one of these mounds every few feet.

“Grubby is a great worker. He is very industrious. Since he is underground, it doesn’t make much difference to him whether it be night or day. In summer, during the hottest part of the day, he rests. His eyes are small and weak because he has little use for them, coming out on the surface very seldom and then usually in the dusk. He has a funny little tail without any hair on it; this is very sensitive and serves him as a sort of guide when he runs backward along his tunnel, which he can do quite fast. A funny thing about those long claws on his front feet is that he folds them under when he is walking or running. Do any of you know why Farmer Brown plows his garden?”

As she asked this, Old Mother Nature looked from one to another, and each in turn shook his head. “It is to mix the dead vegetable matter thoroughly with the earth so that the roots of the plants may get it easily,” explained Old Mother Nature. “By making those tunnels in every direction and bringing up the earth below to the surface, Grubby Gopher does the same thing. That is why I call him my little plowman. He loosens up the hard, packed earth and mixes the vegetable matter with it and so makes it easy for seeds to sprout and plants to grow.”

“Then he must be one of the farmer’s best friends,” spoke up Happy Jack Squirrel.

Old Mother Nature shook her head. “He has been in the past,” said she. “He has done a wonderful work in helping make the land fit for farming. But where land is being farmed he is a dreadful pest, I am sorry to say. You see he eats the crops the farmer tries to raise, and the new mounds he is all the time throwing up bury a lot of the young plants, and in the meadows make it very hard to use a mowing machine for cutting hay. Then Grubby gets into young orchards and cuts off all the tender roots of young trees. This kills them. You see he is fond of tender roots, seeds, stems of grass and grain, and is never happier than when he can find a field of potatoes.

“Being such a worker, he has to have a great deal to eat. Then, too, he stores away a great deal for winter, for he doesn’t sleep in winter as Johnny Chuck does. He even tunnels about under the snow. Sometimes he fills these little snow tunnels with the earth he brings up from below, and when the snow melts it leaves queer little earth ridges to show where the tunnels were.

“Grubby is very neat in his habits and keeps his home and himself very clean. During the day he leaves one of his mounds open for a little while to let in fresh air. But it is only for a little while. Then he closes it again. He doesn’t dare leave it open very long, for fear Shadow the Weasel or a certain big Snake called the Gopher Snake will find it

and come in after him. Digger the Badger is the only one of his enemies who can dig fast enough to dig him out, but at night, when he likes to come out for a little air or to cut grain and grass, he must always watch for Hooty the Owl. Old Man Coyote and members of the Hawk family are always looking for him by day, so you see he has plenty of enemies, like the rest of you.

“He got the name Gopher because that comes from a word meaning honeycomb, and Grubby’s tunnels go in every direction until the ground is like honeycomb. He isn’t a bit social and has rather a mean disposition. He is always ready to fight. On the plains he has done a great deal to make the soil fine and rich, as I have already told you, but on hillsides he does a great deal of harm. The water runs down his tunnels and washes away the soil. Because of this and the damage he does to crops, man is his greatest enemy. But man has furnished him with new and splendid foods easy to get, and so Grubby’s family increases faster than it used to, in spite of traps and poison. Hello! See who’s here! It is about time.”

There was a shuffling and rattling and grunting, and Prickly Porky climbed up on an old stump, looking very peevish and much out of sorts. He had come to school much against his will.

> **End of chapter 10.** Narrate. Chapter 11 follows as an optional second sitting.

The Burgess Animal Book · Chapter 11 · A Fellow With a Thousand Spears

Thornton W. Burgess, The Burgess Animal Book for Children (Boston: Little, Brown, 1920), ch. XI, ***pp. 90–98****. Optional second sitting. Text: Project Gutenberg #2441. Public domain. · This packet: pp. 29–31*

“There,” said Old Mother Nature, pointing to Prickly Porky the Porcupine, “is next to the largest member of your order, which is?”

“Order of Rodents,” piped up Striped Chipmunk.

“He is not only next to the largest, but is the stupidest,” continued Old Mother Nature. “At least that is what people say of him, though I suspect he isn’t as stupid as he sometimes seems. Anyway, he manages to keep well fed and escape his enemies, which is more than can be said for some others who are supposed to have quick wits.”

“Escaping his enemies is no credit to him. They are only too glad to keep out of his way; he doesn’t have to fear anybody,” said Chatterer the Red Squirrel to his cousin, Happy Jack.

His remark didn’t escape the keen ears of Old Mother Nature. “Are you sure about that?” she demanded. “Now there’s Pekan the Fisher-”

She was interrupted by a great rattling on the old stump. Everybody turned to look. There was Prickly Porky backing down as fast as he could, which wasn’t fast at all, and rattling his thousand little spears as he did so. It was really very funny. Everybody had to laugh, even Old Mother Nature. You see, it was plain that he was in a great hurry, yet every movement was slow and clumsy.

“Well, Prickly Porky, what does this mean? Where are you going?” demanded Old Mother Nature.

Prickly Porky turned his dull-looking eyes towards her, and in them was a troubled, worried look. “Where’s Pekan the Fisher?” he asked, and his voice shook a little with something very much like fear.

Old Mother Nature understood instantly. When she had said, “Now there’s Pekan the Fisher,” Prickly Porky had waited to hear no more. He had instantly thought that she meant that Pekan was right there somewhere. “It’s all right, Prickly Porky,” said she. “Pekan isn’t anywhere around here, so climb back on that stump and don’t worry. Had you waited for me to finish, you would have saved yourself a fright. Chatterer had just said that you didn’t have to fear anybody and I was starting to explain that he was wrong, that despite your thousand little spears you have reason to fear Pekan the Fisher.”

Prickly Porky shivered and this made the thousand little spears in his coat rattle. It was such a surprising thing to see Prickly Porky actually afraid that the other little folks almost doubted their own eyes. “Are you quite sure that Pekan isn’t anywhere around?” asked Prickly Porky, and his voice still shook.

“Quite sure,” replied Old Mother Nature. “If he were I wouldn’t allow him to hurt you. You ought to know that. Now sit up so that every one can get a good look at you.”

Prickly Porky sat up, and the others gathered around the foot of the stump to look at him. “He certainly is no beauty,” murmured Happy Jack Squirrel.

Happy Jack was quite right. He was anything but handsome. The truth is he was the homeliest, clumsiest-looking fellow in all the Green Forest. He was a little bigger than Bobby Coon and his body was thick and heavy-looking. His back humped up like an arch. His head was rather small for the size of his body, short and rather round. His neck was even shorter. His eyes were small and very dull. It was plain that he couldn’t see far, or clearly unless what he was

looking at was close at hand. His ears were small and nearly hidden in hair. His front teeth, the gnawing teeth which showed him to be a Rodent, were very large and bright orange. His legs were short and stout. He had four toes on each front foot and five on each hind foot, and these were armed with quite long, stout claws.

But the queerest thing and the most interesting thing about Prickly Porky was his coat. Not one among the other little people of the Green Forest has a coat anything like his. Most of them have a soft, short under fur protected and more or less hidden by longer, coarser hair. Prickly Porky had the long coarse hair and on his back it was very long and coarse, brownish-black in color up to the tips, which were white. Under this long hair was some soft woolly fur, but what that long hair hid chiefly was an array of wicked-looking little spears called quills. They were white to the tips, which were dark and very, very sharply pointed. All down the sides were tiny barbs, so small as hardly to be seen, but there just the same. On his head the quills were about an inch long, but on his back they were four inches long, becoming shorter towards the tail. The latter was rather short, stout, and covered with short quills.

As he sat there on that old stump some of Prickly Porky's little spears could be seen peeping out from the long hair on his back, but they didn't look particularly dangerous. Peter Rabbit suddenly made a discovery. "Why!" he exclaimed. "He hasn't any little spears on the under side of him!"

"I wondered who would be the first to notice that," said Old Mother Nature. "No, Prickly Porky hasn't any little spears underneath, and Pekan the Fisher has found that out. He knows that if he can turn Prickly Porky on his back he can kill him without much danger from those little spears, and he has learned how to do that very thing. That is why Prickly Porky is afraid of him. Now, Prickly Porky, climb down off that stump and show these little folks what you do when an enemy comes near."

Grumbling and growling, Prickly Porky climbed down to the ground. Then he tucked his head down between his front paws and suddenly the thousand little spears appeared all over him, pointing in every direction until he looked like a giant chestnut burr. Then he began to thrash his tail from side to side.

"What is he doing that for?" asked Johnny Chuck, looking rather puzzled.

"Go near enough to be hit by it, and you'll understand," said Old Mother Nature dryly. "That is his one weapon. Whoever is hit by that tail will find himself full of those little spears and will take care never to go near Prickly Porky again. Once those little spears have entered the skin, they keep working in deeper and deeper, and more than one of his enemies has been killed by them. On account of those tiny barbs they are hard to pull out, and pulling them out hurts dreadfully. Just try one and see."

But no one was anxious to try, so Old Mother Nature paused only a moment. "You will notice that he moves that tail quickly," she continued. "It is the only thing about him which is quick. When he has a chance, in time of danger, he likes to get his head under a log or rock, instead of putting it between his paws as he is doing now. Then he plants his feet firmly and waits for a chance to use that tail."

"Is it true that he can throw those little spears at folks?" asked Peter.

Old Mother Nature shook her head. "There isn't a word of truth in it," she declared. "That story probably was started by some one who was hit by his tail, and it was done so quickly that the victim didn't see the tail move and so thought the little spears were thrown at him."

"How does he make all those little spears stand up that way?" asked Jumper the Hare.

"He has a special set of muscles for just that purpose," explained Old Mother Nature.

"When those quills stick into some one they must pull out of Prickly Porky's own skin; I should think that would hurt him," spoke up Striped Chipmunk.

"Not at all," replied Old Mother Nature. "They are very loosely fastened in his skin and come out at the least little pull. New Ones grow to take the place of those he loses. Notice that he puts his whole foot flat on the ground just as Buster Bear and Bobby Coon do, and just as those two-legged creatures called men do. Very few animals do this, and

those that do are said to be plantigrade. Now, Prickly Porky, tell us what you eat and where you make your home, and that will end today's lesson."

"I eat bark, twigs and leaves mostly," grunted Prickly Porky ungraciously. "I like hemlock best of all, but also eat poplar, pine and other trees for a change. Sometimes I stay in a tree for days until I have stripped it of all its bark and leaves. I don't see any sense in moving about any more than is necessary."

"But that must kill the tree!" exclaimed Peter Rabbit.

"Well, what of it?" demanded Prickly Porky crossly. "There are plenty of trees. In summer I like lily pads and always get them when I can."

"Can you swim?" asked Peter eagerly.

"Of course," grunted Prickly Porky.

"I never see you out on the Green Meadows," said Peter.

"And you never will," retorted Prickly Porky. "The Green Forest for me every time. Summer or winter, I'm at home there."

"Don't you sleep through the cold weather the way Buster Bear and I do?" asked Johnny Chuck.

"What should I sleep for?" grumbled Prickly Porky. "Cold weather doesn't bother me. I like it. I have the Green Forest pretty much to myself then. I like to be alone. And as long as there are trees, there is plenty to eat. I sleep a great deal in the daytime because I like night best."

"What about your home?" asked Happy Jack.

"Home is wherever I happen to be, most of the time, but Mrs. Porky has a home in a hollow log or a cave or under the roots of a tree where the babies are born. I guess that's all I've got to tell you."

"You might add that those babies are big for the size of their mother and have a full supply of quills when they are born," said Old Mother Nature. "And you forgot to say how fond of salt you are, and how often this fondness gets you into trouble around the camps of men. Your fear of Pekan the Fisher we all saw. I might add that Puma the Panther is to be feared at times, and when he is very hungry Buster Bear will take a chance on turning you on your back. By the way, don't any of you call Prickly Porky a Hedgehog. He isn't any thing of the kind. He is sometimes called a Quill Pig, but his real name, Porcupine, is best. He has no near relatives. Tomorrow morning, instead of meeting here, we'll hold school on the shore of the pond Paddy the Beaver has made. School is dismissed."

> **End of chapter 11.** If you skip it, it opens Week 11.

READ THIS · FRIDAY · FROM YOUR SHELF

Grimm’s Fairy Tales · one gentle tale

Pantheon edition · owned copy · by title only · never reprinted

Open your Pantheon Grimm.

Suggested: *Mother Holle*. Alternates: *The Fisherman and His Wife* or *The Star-Money* if it’s familiar.

Find it by title in the contents. Read once. Close the book. Narrate. Never reprint.

Saturday

HAVE READY

Bible · Ray's (Lesson 32) · Harvey's · *Understood Betsy* ch. 9 (printed, two sittings) · *Pilgrim's Progress* (printed) · Hillyer CHOW (your copy) · nature notebook · McGuffey nearby

8:00 — **Nature walk** TRACY JOINS

Twenty minutes. One bird, one leaf. Draw one thing later.

8:25 — **Bible · Luke 22:1–13**

Judas and the chief priests; the upper room made ready for the Passover. Read once, narrate the main thread, stop.

8:40 — **Hymn or folk song** TRACY JOINS

Whichever she asks for.

8:50 — **Ray's · Lesson 32**

One lesson. Oral first. That finishes this week's four.

9:10 — **Harvey's · short sitting**

Second sitting of the week. Ten minutes.

9:25 — **Understood Betsy ch. 9 (first part)**

Printed. Read to the marked break (~10 min). Narrate. The rest this afternoon or before next Wednesday.

9:45 — **Pilgrim's Progress**

The Interpreter's house. Printed, about 1,500 words. Narrate. May split after Passion and Patience.

10:05 — **CHOW · A Pirate's Great Grandson**

From your Hillyer. One sitting, ~15 min. Narrate. Never reprint. Dictation is optional today; skip it if the morning is full.

How to teach Saturday

> **Luke, Betsy, Pilgrim's Progress, and Hillyer.** Harvey's second sitting. If the day is busy, keep Bible, Ray's, and Betsy, and move CHOW to next Wednesday.

Bible

Luke 22:1–13. Open your ESV. The chief priests look for a way to put Jesus to death, and Judas agrees to hand Him over for money. Jesus sends Peter and John to follow a man carrying a jar of water, and they make the Passover ready in a large upper room. One reading. Narrate the main thread.

Understood Betsy

The first part ends after Ralph and Betsy talk about the colt and the spruce gum, without mentioning 'Lias. The second part has the Decoration Day exercises, the stolen clothes, Ralph's anger, and Mr. Pond carrying 'Lias away in his buggy. Ask her what Betsy felt at the very end.

Pilgrim's Progress

Each room in the Interpreter's house is a picture with a meaning. Let her narrate the pictures (the dust, the two boys, the fire, the brave man at the door). She doesn't need to explain what they mean. If she asks, give the Interpreter's own answer in a sentence. Next week: the man in the iron cage.

CHOW

"A Pirate's Great Grandson," from your own copy. Rollo the Northman is given Normandy, and his great-great-great-grandson William crosses to England in 1066. She has met both in Little Duke and Island Story. One sitting. Never reprint.

Dictation (optional)

Prepared dictation from *'Come!' said Old Shellover. 'What?' says Creep.* Five minutes, only if she is fresh.

Tracy: nature, Bible as long as she'll sit, song, maybe Betsy listening. McGuffey during Ray's, Harvey's, and CHOW. Week 11 brings Exodus 34–36, Luke 22:14–38, Island Story ch. 31, and Little Duke ch. 6 first half.

READ THIS · SATURDAY

Bible · Luke 22:1–13

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Luke 22:1–13.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.
Judas’s bargain; the upper room made ready. Read once, narrate the main thread.

READ THIS · SATURDAY

Understood Betsy · Chapter 9 · The New Clothes Fail

*Dorothy Canfield Fisher, Understood Betsy (New York: Henry Holt, 1917), ch. IX, **pp. 186–200**. Text: Project Gutenberg #5347. Public domain. Full chapter, in two sittings. · This packet: pp. 36–39*

All the little girls went early to school the next day, eager for the first glimpse of ’Lias in his new clothes. They now quite enjoyed the mystery about who had made them, and were full of agreeable excitement as the little figure was seen approaching down the road. He wore the gray trousers and the little blue shirt; the trousers were a little too long, the shirt a perfect fit. The girls gazed at him with pride as he came on the playground, walking briskly along in the new shoes, which were just the right size. He had been wearing all winter a pair of cast-off women’s shoes. From a distance he looked like another child. But as he came closer ... oh! his face! his hair! his hands! his finger-nails! The little fellow had evidently tried to live up to his beautiful new raiment, for his hair had been roughly put back from his face, and around his mouth and nose was a small area of almost clean skin, where he had made an attempt at washing his face. But he had made practically no impression on the layers of encrusted dirt, and the little girls looked at him ruefully. Mr. Pond would certainly never take a fancy to such a dreadfully grimy child! His new, clean clothes made him look all the worse, as though dirty on purpose!

The little girls retired to their rock-pile and talked over their bitter disappointment, Ralph and the other boys absorbed in a game of marbles near them. ’Lias had gone proudly into the schoolroom to show himself to Miss Benton.

It was the day before Decoration Day and a good deal of time was taken up with practising on the recitations they were going to give at the Decoration Day exercises in the village. Several of the children from each school in the township were to speak pieces in the Town Hall. Betsy was to recite BARBARA FRIETCHIE, her first love in that school, but she droned it over with none of her usual pleasure, her eyes on little ’Lias’s smiling face, so unconscious of its dinginess.

At noon time the boys disappeared down toward the swimming-hole. They often took a swim at noon and nobody thought anything about it on that day. The little girls ate their lunch on their rock, mourning over the failure of their plans, and scheming ways to meet the new obstacle. Stashie suggested, “Couldn’t your Aunt Abigail invite him up to your house for supper and then give him a bath afterward?” But Betsy, although she had never heard of treating a supper-guest in this way, was sure that it was not possible. She shook her head sadly, her eyes on the far-off gleam of white where the boys jumped up and down in their swimming-hole. That was not a good name for it, because there was only one part of it deep enough to swim in. Mostly it was a shallow bay in an arm of the river, where the water was only up to a little boy’s knees and where there was almost no current. The sun beating down on it made it quite warm, and even the first-graders’ mothers allowed them to go in. They only jumped up and down and squealed and splashed each other, but they enjoyed that quite as much as Frank and Harry, the two seventh-graders, enjoyed their swooping dives from the spring-board over the pool. They were late in getting back from the river that day and Miss Benton had to ring her bell hard in that direction before they came trooping up and clattered into the schoolroom, where the girls already sat, their eyes lowered virtuously to their books, with a prim air of self-righteousness. THEY were never late!

Betsy was reciting her arithmetic. She was getting on famously with that. Weeks ago, as soon as Miss Benton had seen the confusion of the little girl’s mind, the two had settled down to a serious struggle with that subject. Miss Benton had had Betsy recite all by herself, so she wouldn’t be flurried by the others; and to begin with had gone back, back, back to bedrock, to things Betsy absolutely knew, to the 2x2’s and the 3x3’s. And then, very cautiously, a step at a time, they had advanced, stopping short whenever Betsy felt a beginning of that bewildered “guessing” impulse which made her answer wildly at random.

After a while, in the dark night which arithmetic had always been to her, Betsy began to make out a few definite outlines, which were always there, facts which she knew to be so without guessing from the expression of her teacher's face. From that moment her progress had been rapid, one sure fact hooking itself on to another, and another one on to that. She attacked a page of problems now with a zest and self-confidence which made her arithmetic lessons among the most interesting hours at school. On that day she was standing up at the board, a piece of chalk in her hand, chewing her tongue and thinking hard how to find out the amount of wall-paper needed for a room 12 feet square with two doors and two windows in it, when her eye fell on little 'Lias, bent over his reading book. She forgot her arithmetic, she forgot where she was. She stared and stared, till Ellen, catching the direction of her eyes, looked and stared too. Little 'Lias was CLEAN, preternaturally, almost wetly clean. His face was clean and shining, his ears shone pink and fair, his hands were absolutely spotless, even his hay-colored hair was clean and, still damp, brushed flatly back till it shone in the sun. Betsy blinked her eyes a great many times, thinking she must be dreaming, but every time she opened them there was 'Lias, looking white and polished like a new willow whistle.

Somebody poked her hard in the ribs. She started and, turning, saw Ralph, who was doing a sum beside her on the board, scowling at her under his black brows. "Quit gawking at 'Lias," he said under his breath. "You make me tired!" Something conscious and shame-faced in his manner made Betsy understand at once what had happened. Ralph had taken 'Lias down to the little boys' wading-place and had washed him all over. She remembered now that they had a piece of yellow soap there.

Her face broke into a radiant smile and she began to say something to Ralph about how nice that was of him, but he frowned again and said, crossly, "Aw, cut it out! Look at what you've done there! If I couldn't 9 x 8 and get it right!"

"How queer boys are!" thought Betsy, erasing her mistake and putting down the right answer. But she did not try to speak to Ralph again about 'Lias, not even after school, when she saw 'Lias going home with a new cap on his head which she recognized as Ralph's. She just looked at Ralph's bare head, and smiled her eyes at him, keeping the rest of her face sober, the way Cousin Ann did. For just a minute Ralph almost smiled back. At least he looked quite friendly. They stepped along toward home together, the first time Ralph had ever condescended to walk beside a girl.

"We got a new colt," he said.

"Have you?" she said. "What color?"

"Black, with a white star, and they're going to let me ride him when he's old enough."

"My! Won't that be nice!" said Betsy.

And all the time they were both thinking of little 'Lias with his new clothes and his sweet, thin face shining with cleanliness.

"Do you like spruce gum?" asked Ralph.

"Oh, I LOVE gum!" said Betsy.

"Well, I'll bring you down a chunk tomorrow, if I don't forget it," said Ralph, turning off at the cross-roads.

They had not mentioned 'Lias at all.

> **Break here** for the first sitting. The rest can be read Saturday afternoon or before next Wednesday.

SECOND SITTING

The next day they were to have school only in the morning. In the afternoon they were to go in a big hay-wagon down to the village to the "exercises." 'Lias came to school in his new blue-serge trousers and his white blouse. The little girls gloated over his appearance, and hung around him, for who was to "visit school" that morning but Mr. Pond himself! Cousin Ann had arranged it somehow. It took Cousin Ann to fix things! During recess, as they were playing still-pond-no-more-moving on the playground, Mr. Pond and Uncle Henry drew up to the edge of the playground, stopped their horse, and, talking and laughing together, watched the children at play. Betsy looked hard at the big, burly, kind-faced man with the smiling eyes and the hearty laugh, and decided that he would "do" perfectly

for ’Lias. But what she decided was to have little importance, apparently, for after all he would not get out of the wagon, but said he’d have to drive right on to the village. Just like that, with no excuse other than a careless glance at his watch. No, he guessed he wouldn’t have time, this morning, he said. Betsy cast an imploring look up into Uncle Henry’s face, but evidently he felt himself quite helpless, too. Oh, if only Cousin Ann had come! SHE would have marched him into the schoolhouse double-quick. But Uncle Henry was not Cousin Ann, and though Betsy saw him, as they drove away, conscientiously point out little ’Lias, resplendent and shining, Mr. Pond only nodded absently, as though, he were thinking of something else.

Betsy could have cried with disappointment; but she and the other girls, putting their heads together for comfort, told each other that there was time enough yet. Mr. Pond would not leave town till tomorrow. Perhaps ... there was still some hope.

But that afternoon even this last hope was dashed. As they gathered at the schoolhouse, the girls fresh and crisp in their newly starched dresses, with red or blue hair-ribbons, the boys very self-conscious in their dark suits, clean collars, new caps (all but Ralph), and blacked shoes, there was no little ’Lias. They waited and waited, but there was no sign of him. Finally Uncle Henry, who was to drive the straw-ride down to town, looked at his watch, gathered up the reins, and said they would be late if they didn’t start right away. Maybe ’Lias had had a chance to ride in with somebody else.

They all piled in, the horses stepped off, the wheels grated on the stones. And just at that moment a dismal sound of sobbing wails reached them from the woodshed back of the schoolhouse. The children tumbled out as fast as they had tumbled in, and ran back, Betsy and Ralph at their head. There in the woodshed was little ’Lias, huddled in the corner behind some wood, crying and crying and crying, digging his fists into his eyes, his face all smeared with tears and dirt. And he was dressed again in his filthy, torn old overalls and ragged shirt. His poor little bare feet shone with a piteous cleanliness in that dark place.

“What’s the matter? What’s the matter?” the children asked him all at once. He flung himself on Ralph, burying his face in the other boy’s coat, and sobbed out some disjointed story which only Ralph could hear ... and then as last and final climax of the disaster, who should come looking over the shoulders of the children but Uncle Henry AND Mr. Pond! And ’Lias all ragged and dirty again! Betsy sat down weakly on a pile of wood, utterly disheartened. What was the use of anything!

“What’s the matter?” asked the two men together.

Ralph turned, with an angry toss of his dark head, and told them bitterly, over the heads of the children: “He just had some decent clothes.... First ones he’s EVER had! And he was plotting on going to the exercises in the Town Hall. And that darned old skunk of a stepfather has gone and taken ’em and sold ’em to get whiskey. I’d like to KILL him!”

Betsy could have flung her arms around Ralph, he looked so exactly the way she felt. “Yes, he is a darned old skunk!” she said to herself, rejoicing in the bad words she did not know before. It TOOK bad words to qualify what had happened.

She saw an electric spark pass from Ralph’s blazing eyes to Mr. Pond’s broad face, now grim and fierce. She saw Mr. Pond step forward, brushing the children out of his way, like a giant among dwarfs. She saw him stoop and pick little ’Lias up in his great, strong arms, and, holding him close, stride furiously out of the woodshed, across the playground to the buggy which was waiting for him.

“He’ll go to the exercises all right!” he called back over his shoulder in a great roar. “He’ll go, if I have to buy out the whole town to get him an outfit! And that whelp won’t get these clothes, either; you hear me say so!”

He sprang into the buggy and, holding ’Lias on his lap, took up the reins and drove rapidly forward.

They saw little ’Lias again, entering the Town Hall, holding fast to Mr. Pond’s hand. He was magnificent in a whole suit of store clothes, coat and all, and he wore white stockings and neat, low shoes, like a city child!

They saw him later, up on the platform, squeaking out his little patriotic poem, his eyes, shining like stars, fixed on one broad, smiling face in the audience. When he finished he was overcome with shyness by the applause, and for a moment forgot to turn and leave the platform. He hung his head, and, looking out from under his eyebrows, gave a quaint, shy little smile at the audience. Betsy saw Mr. Pond's great smile waver and grow dim. His eyes filled so full that he had to take out his handkerchief and blow his nose loudly.

And they saw little 'Lias once more, for the last time. Mr. Pond's buggy drove rapidly past their slow-moving hay-wagon, Mr. Pond holding the reins masterfully in one hand. Beside him, very close, sat 'Lias with his lap full of toys, oh, FULL—like Christmas! In that fleeting glimpse they saw a toy train, a stuffed dog, a candy-box, a pile of picture-books, tops, paper-bags, and even the swinging crane of the big mechanical toy dredge that everybody said the storekeeper could never sell to anybody because it cost so much!

As they passed swiftly, 'Lias looked out at them and waved his little hand flutteringly. His other hand was tightly clasped in Mr. Pond's big one. He was smiling at them all. His eyes looked dazed and radiant. He turned his head as the buggy flashed by to call out, in a shrill, exulting little shout, "Good-bye! Good-bye! I'm going to live with ..." They could hear no more. He was gone, only his little hand still waving at them over the back of the buggy seat.

Betsy drew a long, long breath. She found that Ralph was looking at her. For a moment she couldn't think what made him look so different. Then she saw that he was smiling. She had never seen him smile before. He smiled at her as though he were sure she would understand, and never said a word. Betsy looked forward again and saw the gleaming buggy vanishing over the hill in front of them. She smiled back at Ralph silently.

Not a thing had happened the way she had planned; no, not a single thing! But it seemed to her she had never been so happy in her life.

> **End of chapter 9.** Next week: chapter 10, Betsy Has a Birthday.

READ THIS · SATURDAY

The Pilgrim’s Progress · The Interpreter’s house: the dusty parlour to the valiant man

John Bunyan, The Pilgrim’s Progress (London: J. M. Dent; New York: E. P. Dutton, 1910 edition, illustrated by Frank C. Papé), ***pp. 31–35****. Text: Project Gutenberg #131 (bracketed Scripture references and section numbers removed). Public domain. About 1,500 words; may be split. · This packet: pp. 40–42*

Then he took him by the hand, and led him into a very large parlour that was full of dust, because never swept; the which after he had reviewed a little while, the Interpreter called for a man to sweep. Now, when he began to sweep, the dust began so abundantly to fly about, that Christian had almost therewith been choked. Then said the Interpreter to a damsel that stood by, Bring hither the water, and sprinkle the room; the which, when she had done, it was swept and cleansed with pleasure.

CHR. Then said Christian, What means this?

INTER. The Interpreter answered, This parlour is the heart of a man that was never sanctified by the sweet grace of the gospel; the dust is his original sin and inward corruptions, that have defiled the whole man. He that began to sweep at first, is the Law; but she that brought water, and did sprinkle it, is the Gospel. Now, whereas thou sawest, that so soon as the first began to sweep, the dust did so fly about that the room by him could not be cleansed, but that thou wast almost choked therewith; this is to shew thee, that the law, instead of cleansing the heart (by its working) from sin, doth revive, put strength into, and increase it in the soul, even as it doth discover and forbid it, for it doth not give power to subdue.

Again, as thou sawest the damsel sprinkle the room with water, upon which it was cleansed with pleasure; this is to show thee, that when the gospel comes in the sweet and precious influences thereof to the heart, then, I say, even as thou sawest the damsel lay the dust by sprinkling the floor with water, so is sin vanquished and subdued, and the soul made clean through the faith of it, and consequently fit for the King of glory to inhabit.

I saw, moreover, in my dream, that the Interpreter took him by the hand, and had him into a little room, where sat two little children, each one in his chair. The name of the eldest was Passion, and the name of the other Patience. Passion seemed to be much discontented; but Patience was very quiet. Then Christian asked, What is the reason of the discontent of Passion? The Interpreter answered, The Governor of them would have him stay for his best things till the beginning of the next year; but he will have all now: but Patience is willing to wait.

Then I saw that one came to Passion, and brought him a bag of treasure, and poured it down at his feet, the which he took up and rejoiced therein, and withal laughed Patience to scorn. But I beheld but a while, and he had lavished all away, and had nothing left him but rags.

CHR. Then said Christian to the Interpreter, Expound this matter more fully to me.

INTER. So he said, These two lads are figures: Passion, of the men of this world; and Patience, of the men of that which is to come; for as here thou seest, Passion will have all now this year, that is to say, in this world; so are the men of this world, they must have all their good things now, they cannot stay till next year, that is until the next world, for their portion of good. That proverb, ‘A bird in the hand is worth two in the bush’, is of more authority with them than are all the Divine testimonies of the good of the world to come. But as thou sawest that he had quickly lavished all away, and had presently left him nothing but rags; so will it be with all such men at the end of this world.

CHR. Then said Christian, Now I see that Patience has the best wisdom, and that upon many accounts. First, because he stays for the best things. Second, and also because he will have the glory of his, when the other has nothing but rags.

INTER. Nay, you may add another, to wit, the glory of the next world will never wear out; but these are suddenly gone. Therefore Passion had not so much reason to laugh at Patience, because he had his good things first, as Patience will have to laugh at Passion, because he had his best things last; for first must give place to last, because last must have his time to come; but last gives place to nothing; for there is not another to succeed. He, therefore, that hath his portion first, must needs have a time to spend it; but he that hath his portion last, must have it lastingly; therefore it is said of Dives, “Thou in thy life-time receivedst thy good things, and likewise Lazarus evil things; but now he is comforted, and thou art tormented.”

CHR. Then I perceive it is not best to covet things that are now, but to wait for things to come.

INTER. You say the truth: “For the things which are seen are temporal; but the things which are not seen are eternal.” But though this be so, yet since things present and our fleshly appetite are such near neighbours one to another; and again, because things to come, and carnal sense, are such strangers one to another; therefore it is, that the first of these so suddenly fall into amity, and that distance is so continued between the second.

> **Optional break.** If she is tired, stop here and read the fire and the palace another day.

SECOND SITTING

Then I saw in my dream that the Interpreter took Christian by the hand, and led him into a place where was a fire burning against a wall, and one standing by it, always casting much water upon it, to quench it; yet did the fire burn higher and hotter.

Then said Christian, What means this?

The Interpreter answered, This fire is the work of grace that is wrought in the heart; he that casts water upon it, to extinguish and put it out, is the Devil; but in that thou seest the fire notwithstanding burn higher and hotter, thou shalt also see the reason of that. So he had him about to the backside of the wall, where he saw a man with a vessel of oil in his hand, of the which he did also continually cast, but secretly, into the fire.

Then said Christian, What means this?

The Interpreter answered, This is Christ, who continually, with the oil of his grace, maintains the work already begun in the heart: by the means of which, notwithstanding what the devil can do, the souls of his people prove gracious still. And in that thou sawest that the man stood behind the wall to maintain the fire, that is to teach thee that it is hard for the tempted to see how this work of grace is maintained in the soul.

I saw also, that the Interpreter took him again by the hand, and led him into a pleasant place, where was builded a stately palace, beautiful to behold; at the sight of which Christian was greatly delighted. He saw also, upon the top thereof, certain persons walking, who were clothed all in gold.

Then said Christian, May we go in thither?

Then the Interpreter took him, and led him up towards the door of the palace; and behold, at the door stood a great company of men, as desirous to go in; but durst not. There also sat a man at a little distance from the door, at a table-side, with a book and his inkhorn before him, to take the name of him that should enter therein; he saw also, that in the doorway stood many men in armour to keep it, being resolved to do the men that would enter what hurt and mischief they could. Now was Christian somewhat in amaze. At last, when every man started back for fear of the armed men, Christian saw a man of a very stout countenance come up to the man that sat there to write, saying, Set down my name, Sir: the which when he had done, he saw the man draw his sword, and put a helmet upon his head, and rush toward the door upon the armed men, who laid upon him with deadly force; but the man, not at all discouraged, fell to cutting and hacking most fiercely. So after he had received and given many wounds to those that attempted to keep him out, he cut his way through them all, and pressed forward into the palace, at which there was a pleasant voice heard from those that were within, even of those that walked upon the top of the palace, saying—

“Come in, come in; Eternal glory thou shalt win.”

So he went in, and was clothed with such garments as they. Then Christian smiled and said; I think verily I know the meaning of this.

> **Stop here.** Next week: the man in the iron cage, and the dream of the Judgment.

OPEN YOUR COPY · SATURDAY

A Child’s History of the World · A Pirate’s Great Grandson

V. M. Hillyer — owned copy · ch. 52 in newer printings, ch. 50 in the 1924 first edition · never reprinted in this packet

Open your Hillyer to “A Pirate’s Great Grandson.”

One sitting, ~15 min. Read once, close the book, narrate, stop.

Follows Week 9’s “Knights and Days of Chivalry.” Rollo is Little Duke Richard’s grandfather.

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READ THIS · SATURDAY · FROM YOUR SHELF

Harvey’s Elementary Grammar · short sitting

Mott Media reprint · owned copy · never reprinted

Open Harvey’s to your place.

About ten minutes. Oral and light. Second sitting of the week. Stop.

Do not dump the book.

HOLD ALL WEEK · FROM YOUR SHELF

Ray’s New Practical Arithmetic · Lessons 29–32

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One lesson each school day.

Wednesday Lesson 29 · Thursday Lesson 30 · Friday Lesson 31 · Saturday Lesson 32.

Oral first when the book allows. Stop after one lesson. Tracy: McGuffey picture-pages nearby.

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WED + THU ONLY · FROM YOUR SHELF

Awana workbook

Physical workbook · never reprinted

After Bible, Wed and Thu only.

Ten to fifteen minutes. Next page or section in their physical Awana book. Then put it away.

No Awana Friday or Saturday. Never reprint Awana.